

Moderator script — Protocol A · Engineers

30 min · moderated · screen share · think-aloud Covers RQ1 (triggers), RQ2 (friction), RQ3 (comprehension). Full rationale: [layers-session.md](#) Session 3.

Before you start: Flask running? `curl 127.0.0.1:5001` — if it's down, DoubleCheck fails and probes 8–10 need the screenshot fallback. Recording on. Capture sheet open.

0–3 · Setup

Read aloud:

"Thanks for doing this. This is a proof of concept I built — I'm testing it, not you. If something's confusing, that's exactly the finding I need, so please don't work around it quietly.

Two things: think out loud as much as you can, even half-formed thoughts. And it only evaluates buttons — that's a deliberate limit, not something you've missed."

Confirm recording consent.

3–9 · RQ1 · Retrospective

Open with:

"Tell me about the last time you shipped, or nearly shipped, a component with an accessibility problem. Walk me through what was happening."

Follow their story. Don't lead it.

- "What made you notice?"
- "What did you reach for first?"
- "What did you do when that didn't settle it?"
- "Who else got involved, and when?"

Listen for: nouns they use naturally · workarounds they invented.

 **Move on at 9:00 even mid-story.** The task matters more.

9–21 · RQ2 · Task, unaided

Hand over screen control. Say only:

"Find out whether this button is accessible enough to ship."

Say nothing else. Do not mention the panel. **No help for the first 90 seconds of any stall** — silence is the data.

If they're still stuck past 90s: *"What are you looking for right now?"* — then wait again. Only rescue if the session is at risk.

Watch for → capture sheet:

- Did they find the panel trigger unaided? How long?
- Time to first completed evaluation
- Did they switch theme unprompted?
- Did they run DoubleCheck without being told it exists?
- Did they reach a ship / don't-ship decision — and on what basis?
- Every hesitation + what was on screen

21–28 · RQ3 · Comprehension probes

Never explain before they answer. Ask, wait, record verbatim.

Score meaning

1. (*point at score*) "What does this number tell you?"
2. "What would make it go up?"

Score subject — if they didn't switch theme themselves, do it now 3. "Same button. Light mode says 85, dark says 100. What do you make of that?" 4. "So what's this component's score?"

Evidence gaps — switch to the **no-CSS fixture** 5. "What does Unknown mean here?" 6. "Is Unknown better or worse than Fail?" 7. **"Would you ship this?"** ← record yes/no exactly

Verdict subject 8. (*point at DoubleCheck verdict*) "This says PASS. What is it saying passed?"

Action 9. "What would you do next?" 10. (*if Approve is showing*) "What does approving this mean? Who's it for?"

28–30 · Close

"Is there anything I haven't asked that would help me understand this better?"

Optional, only if time genuinely remains: let them paste their own component. Mark anything from it as discounted — the `.btn` selector match means Unknowns may be artefacts, not real evidence gaps.

Thank them. Stop recording.